Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 8 – Recovery System

Objective

Maximize adaptation from training by improving sleep, hydration, fatigue management, mobility, and overall recovery.

Recovery Factor	Target
Sleep	8–9 hours every night
Hydration	3–3.5 L water/day
Protein	110–140 g/day
Daily Steps	8,000–10,000+
Mobility	10 minutes on Wednesday and Sunday
Deload	Every 6–8 weeks or when recovery indicators decline

Sleep Strategy

Maintain a consistent bedtime and wake time. Limit bright screens before bed, keep the room cool and dark, and avoid large meals immediately before sleeping.

Hydration Strategy

Drink water steadily throughout the day rather than consuming most of it at once. Increase intake on hot days or after long cricket and pickleball sessions.

Managing Muscle Soreness

Light walking, mobility work, and adequate protein usually improve soreness more effectively than complete inactivity. Mild soreness is acceptable; sharp pain is not.

Recovery Warning Signs

Reduce training load or consider an extra recovery day if several of these occur together:
• Performance drops for more than one week
• Poor sleep for several nights
• Persistent joint pain
• Loss of motivation
• Elevated fatigue throughout the day

Coach's Recovery Checklist

Before each workout ask yourself:
✓ Slept at least 7.5–8 hours?
✓ Ate enough protein yesterday?
✓ Hydrated?

✓ Warmed up properly?
✓ Pain-free to train?

Recovery Priorities

For your current situation, the biggest improvements will come from increasing daily protein, drinking more water, and maintaining consistent training. These are likely to have a greater impact than adding supplements or advanced recovery methods.